

WEEK 5 OF 4 • Breath

Script 5: The Long Exhale (Cool Down)**Theme: Recovery and Regulation**

Rationale: After high-intensity sparring or drills, the heart rate is high. This script focuses on elongating the exhale, which biologically triggers the parasympathetic nervous system to calm the body down.

Request that students sit comfortably or lie on their backs if appropriate. Remind them of the "out."

"After a hard fight, the warrior must return to peace. If we stay ramped up, we cannot recover. Close your eyes. Notice how fast your heart is beating. Don't judge it; just feel it.

We are going to signal the heart to slow down by making our exhale twice as long as our inhale.

Inhale through your nose for a count of 2. Exhale through your mouth like you are cooling hot soup for a count of 4.

Inhale (1... 2). Exhale (1... 2... 3... 4). Feel your shoulders drop as you breathe out.

Let's lengthen it. Inhale for 3. Exhale for 6. (Pause for 30 seconds of guided counting.)

Notice how your heart rate has settled. You have switched from 'fight' mode to 'recover' mode."



MINDFULNESS ON THE MATS

MINDFULNESS ON THE MATS